

Further Listening Unit 3 P46

Conversation:

1 What is one reason that makes Big Sky Park attractive to the couple?

- A It is right in their city.
- B It is an entertainment park.
- C It has nice trails and camping sites.
- D It's a park with a beautiful city skyline.

2 What problem do they try to figure out about going to the park?

- A Where the No. 32 bus stop is.
- B What the best route to drive to the park is.
- C Whether they can find easy parking for their car.
- D How they can get their camping equipment on the bus.

3 What will the woman do before their trip?

- A Buy a big backpack.
- B Bake a chocolate cake.
- C Order their favorite food.
- D Make a detailed trip plan.

4 What does the couple long to do at the park?

- A Drink coffee around a campfire.
- B Have a leisurely barbecue dinner.
- C Walk together in the beauty of nature.
- D Take a bike ride around the open spaces.

Scripts:

M: Rebecca, I just learned of an amazing park right near our city!

W: Really? Is it a nature park or an entertainment park?

M: It's a beautiful nature park, located 15 miles from our home.

W: What's it called?

M: It's called Big Sky Park, and I heard it has nice walking trails and camping sites!

W: Bill, this is perfect! We can have a nice vacation without traveling somewhere distant, so we can still keep saving money to buy our dream car. But, can we get to Big Sky Park without a car?

M: Yes, easily. We just take the No. 32 bus, which goes right to the main gate of the park. The only problem, I suppose, will be getting all of our camping stuff with us on the bus.

W: Well, I did just buy that new cart to help carry groceries home on the bus. Plus, we have your big backpack. Together, I think we will be fine. All of our camping equipment should easily fit on the bus.

M: Good, good! I know we can make it a really special vacation.

I have longed for a time when we could walk leisurely together in the quiet beauty of nature. I'm

so, so excited that the chance is finally here.

W: I know, me too! I know what I'll do before we go! I'll pack all of our favorite food and bake a small chocolate cake. Your favorite! Then, in the park, we can drink tea, eat cake, and chat about anything we like around a campfire. I'm so happy you found Big Sky Park. I can't wait – just two more days until the vacation starts!

M: I'm so happy as well. Big Sky Park will be wonderful. The fire, the dinner, and the time spent with you there will make me such a happy, happy man, Rebecca!

Passage:

1 Why should visitors hurry if they want to see the exhibits in the new museum?

- A The exhibition will last for no more than a week.
- B The museum opens only during the holiday season.
- C The museum workers will soon begin their vacation.
- D Large crowds of visitors will come to the unusual show.

2 What is exhibited in the new museum?

- A Plenty of televisions that look stylish.
- B Anything that reflects modern fashion.
- C Beds and sofas that make people feel relaxed.
- D Objects that have brought big lifestyle changes.

3 What is the purpose of the exhibition?

- A To offer a place to rest in our fast-paced societies.
- B To provide a practical experience for people to think about laziness.
- C To teach lazy people how to change their behavior and lifestyle.
- D To show how furniture has changed to meet the needs of modern people.

4 What did the museum's founder advise us to do?

- A Consider laziness an enemy of work.
- B Slow down, relax, and be lazy for a while.
- C Make efforts to shorten our working week.
- D Enjoy our leisure time if our jobs allow us to.

Scripts:

A new museum entirely dedicated to laziness has opened in the capital city of Colombia. But you have to hurry if you want to see the exhibits and learn about being lazy because the exhibition lasts only for one week. The unusual show displays a whole range of things, such as sofas, beds, and anything that encourages rest. There are also plenty of televisions for those visiting couch potatoes to watch as they move around the museum.

It is no coincidence but rather an intentional decision for the museum to have opened right after the holiday season. The idea is for people to think about laziness, and perhaps change their behavior and lifestyle throughout the rest of the year. It offers a practical experience to make us think about laziness in our high-speed, fast-paced societies.

The museum's founder, Marcela Arrieta, said she wanted people to rethink laziness and decide whether it really is such a bad thing. She told the media that people today always think about laziness as an enemy of work. For example, they may feel guilty if they sleep late, or they may feel that they are wasting time after taking a nap or having a holiday.

Ms. Arrieta may not be proposing that we should have a shorter working week, but she could have a point in that we do need more leisure time than our jobs allow us, and that we should change our lifestyle to one that is more relaxing. Besides, according to scientists, avoiding the pressure and stress of work can make us healthier and live longer. So, why not try out Ms. Arrieta's advice for yourself: Slow down, and think about being lazy?

Lectures:

Lecture 1

1 What is the main feature of niche tourism?

- A It offers budget-friendly travel packages.
- B It focuses on popular tourist destinations.
- C It provides opportunities for unique experiences.
- D It specializes in historical and geographical sites.

2 Which types of niche travel experienced the biggest growth from 2018 to 2021?

- A Adventure and wildlife trips.
- B Wellness and friendship trips.
- C Low-risk and conventional trips.
- D Cookery and eco-friendliness trips.

3 What tip is offered for finding niche travel?

- A Consulting with a travel advisor.
- B Following the advice of tourism analysts.
- C Doing thorough research through various sources.
- D Contacting an operator focusing on immersive vacations.

4 What does the lecture suggest about the future of niche travel?

- A It will decline in popularity.
- B It will attract all age groups.
- C It will remain a niche market.
- D It will become fairly mainstream.

Scripts:

Good morning, everyone. Today, I'm going to talk about a fascinating aspect of the tourism industry known as niche tourism. Niche tourism provides travelers with the opportunity to explore and experience unique and distinctive destinations that cater to their specific interests and preferences. This can include exploring special historical or geographical sites, participating in unique and authentic experiences, or engaging with local communities and cultures in meaningful

ways.

According to a report published recently by a world-leading data and analytics company, niche tourism is growing most rapidly among the young generation, specifically those born in the late 1990s and early 2000s.

In the question of whether or not you are more likely to be influenced by tourism products that are tailored to your specific needs, the survey conducted by the company found that young adults were the group most likely to answer “yes”. Nearly 27 percent of them responded that this would always influence their choice, and that they would always prefer a personalized product over a more generalized, one-size-fits-all one. This figure is three percent higher than the global average, which might indicate a growing trend toward niche travel among the young generation.

The report also touched on some of the different types of niche travel and whether the desire for them grew from 2018 to 2021. It was found that trips focusing on adventure, cookery, wellness, or eco-friendliness grew the most over the four years.

Why do young adults seem to prefer niche travel? In the opinion of some tourism analysts, young adults yearn for more engaging and meaningful experiences. To them, experiences are more important than other factors, including cost.

To find niche travel, the biggest tip offered is to check with a travel advisor. Travel advisors are uniquely knowledgeable, and many specialize in travel types, destinations, and even specific brands.

When you plan your niche trip, you should first figure out which type you actually want to experience. If you want an immersive vacation in just one destination, you might consider a tour with an operator that focuses on deep and engaging experiences. If you want an eco-friendly vacation, you should consider factors like reducing carbon emissions while traveling, which can be achieved by using public transportation or biking, among other things.

The young generation is leading the growth in niche travel, and will soon become the dominant group in the travel industry. Who knows what other fun travel trends they’ ll share with us next? Either way, it’s clear that niche travel is here to stay.

Lecture 2:

1 What can we learn about the development of the term “forest bathing” from the lecture?

- A It first originated in Japan in the early 1980s.
- B It was initially used to refer to swimming in forest ponds.
- C It was first used by people who did regular walking in nature.
- D It was coined by scientists studying the effects of nature on health.

2 How long does a person need to spend in nature each week to experience the benefits of forest bathing, according to one study?

- A No more than 10 minutes.
- B No more than 20 minutes.
- C At least 120 minutes.
- D At least 250 minutes.

3 Besides the duration of time spent in nature, what is another factor that may contribute to the positive effects of forest bathing?

- A Being exposed to new experiences.
- B Experiencing feelings of awe in nature.
- C Resolving personal problems and concerns.
- D Engaging in high-intensity physical exercise.

4 Which of the following statements is supported by scientific literature?

- A Forest bathing has powerful restorative effects.
- B Forest bathing provides rather short-term benefits.
- C Forest bathing can be regarded as a kind of medical treatment.
- D Forest bathing becomes increasingly effective as time spent in nature increases.

Scripts:

If someone told you there was a lifehack that could help reduce your blood pressure, calm your heart rate, improve your mood, and give you feelings of contentment and life satisfaction, would you take their advice? Whether or not it sounds reasonable, it's true, and it's called "forest bathing". Simply taking time out of your schedule to go for a walk in nature has been consistently found to have powerful, restorative effects on your physical and mental health.

"Forest bathing" is a term developed in Japan in the early 1980s. It has been defined as "making contact with and taking in the atmosphere of the forest". The benefits of forest bathing have been well-documented by an ever-growing group of studies and scientific literature. By merely walking amongst the trees and listening to the sounds of the wind, the leaves, and the birds, people can experience a significant reduction in their levels of stress, depression, and anxiety. They can also feel a soothing sense of comfort and improved feelings of calm refreshment, becoming more energized and vigorous.

Some studies suggest that forest bathing has to last longer than 20 minutes to secure these powerful and positive effects, while others conclude that you could experience benefits from as little as 10 minutes in natural areas. Another study, published in Scientific Reports, concludes that to get these benefits, one needs to spend at least 120 minutes in nature every week. Each visit does not need to be the same length – you can string together a few short visits or take one two-hour hike at a time. After about 250 minutes in nature each week, though, this study finds that participants hit the maximum level of benefit, and more time spent in forest bathing then will not offer any further gain.

In addition to the duration of time spent immersing oneself in nature, there are discussions about other factors that may contribute to the positive effects of forest bathing. One such factor revolves around the concept of "awe". In other words, the experience of being amazed by something bigger than yourself and the ability to place your own problems in the context of something huge, powerful, and hard to understand could be good for you.

No matter how it works, forest bathing clearly functions as a valuable, reliable stress release and affirms our good feelings about ourselves and our future.

Keys:

Conversation: CDBC

Passage: A C B B

Lecture 1: C D A D

Lecture 2: A C B A